

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Issue-Based Prompt Scoping - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Issue-Based Prompt Scoping - Solved Practice Workbook 6

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 6

Q1. Which option applies Purpose and scope as an Essay-method distinction?	6
Q2. Which use of Purpose and scope stays closest to the printed prompt?	6
Q3. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Purpose and scope?	6
Q4. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Purpose and scope?	7
Q5. Which option applies Core terms in plain language as an Essay-method distinction?	7
Q6. Which use of Core terms in plain language stays closest to the printed prompt?	7
Q7. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Core terms in plain language?	7
Q8. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Core terms in plain language?	8
Q9. Which option applies Core terms in plain language - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?	8
Q10. Which use of Core terms in plain language - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?	8
Q11. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Core terms in plain language - 2?	8
Q12. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Core terms in plain language - 2?	8
Q13. Which option applies Exam facts / source basis as an Essay-method distinction?	9
Q14. Which use of Exam facts / source basis stays closest to the printed prompt?	9
Q15. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Exam facts / source basis?	9
Q16. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Exam facts / source basis?	9
Q17. Which option applies Exam facts / source basis - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?	10
Q18. Which use of Exam facts / source basis - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?	10
Q19. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Exam facts / source basis - 2?	10
Q20. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Exam facts / source basis - 2?	10
Q21. Which option applies Exam facts / source basis - 3 as an Essay-method distinction?	11
Q22. Which use of Exam facts / source basis - 3 stays closest to the printed prompt?	11
Q23. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Exam facts / source basis - 3?	11
Q24. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Exam facts / source basis - 3?	11
Q25. Which option applies Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test as an Essay-method distinction?	12
Q26. Which use of Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test stays closest to the printed prompt?	12
Q27. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test?	12

Q28. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test? . . .	12
Q29. Which option applies Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	13
Q30. Which use of Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	13
Q31. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2? . . .	13
Q32. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2? . . .	14
Q33. Which option applies Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	14
Q34. Which use of Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	15
Q35. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3? . . .	15
Q36. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3? . . .	15
Q37. Which option applies The central idea and common misreading as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	16
Q38. Which use of The central idea and common misreading stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	16
Q39. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for The central idea and common misreading? . .	16
Q40. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about The central idea and common misreading? . . .	17
Q41. Which option applies Basic decomposition questions as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	17
Q42. Which use of Basic decomposition questions stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	17
Q43. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Basic decomposition questions? . . .	18
Q44. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Basic decomposition questions? . . .	18
Q45. Which option applies Causal-evidence-limit chain as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	19
Q46. Which use of Causal-evidence-limit chain stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	19
Q47. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Causal-evidence-limit chain? . . .	19
Q48. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Causal-evidence-limit chain? . . .	19
Q49. Which option applies Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	20
Q50. Which use of Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	20
Q51. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2? . . .	20
Q52. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2? . . .	20
Q53. Which option applies India-first illustration starters as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	21
Q54. Which use of India-first illustration starters stays closest to the printed prompt? . . .	21
Q55. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for India-first illustration starters? . . .	21
Q56. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about India-first illustration starters? . . .	21
Q57. Which option applies Advanced proposition and boundary as an Essay-method distinction? . . .	22

Q58. Which use of Advanced proposition and boundary stays closest to the printed prompt?	22
Q59. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Advanced proposition and boundary?	22
Q60. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Advanced proposition and boundary?	23
Q61. Which option applies Concept definition and taxonomy as an Essay-method distinction?	23
Q62. Which use of Concept definition and taxonomy stays closest to the printed prompt?	23
Q63. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Concept definition and taxonomy?	23
Q64. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Concept definition and taxonomy?	24
Q65. Which option applies Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?	24
Q66. Which use of Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?	24
Q67. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Concept definition and taxonomy - 2?	24
Q68. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Concept definition and taxonomy - 2?	24
Q69. Which option applies Tension pairs and hidden assumptions as an Essay-method distinction?	25
Q70. Which use of Tension pairs and hidden assumptions stays closest to the printed prompt?	25
Q71. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Tension pairs and hidden assumptions?	25
Q72. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Tension pairs and hidden assumptions?	25
Q73. Which option applies Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?	26
Q74. Which use of Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?	26
Q75. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2?	26
Q76. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2?	26
Q77. Which option applies Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 as an Essay-method distinction?	27
Q78. Which use of Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 stays closest to the printed prompt?	27
Q79. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3?	27
Q80. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3?	27

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 28

AUDITED TOPIC-SPECIFIC PYQ OWNERSHIP	28
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024-B5 Essay	28
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023-B5 Essay	28
PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2019-B7 Essay	28
COMPLETE MODEL ESSAYS	29
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	30
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	31
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	31

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS 33

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS 34

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS 36

Issue-Based Prompt Scoping - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which option applies Purpose and scope as an Essay-method distinction?

A. A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. B. Treat Purpose and scope as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Replace Purpose and scope with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Use Purpose and scope to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q2. Which use of Purpose and scope stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Use Purpose and scope while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. B. A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. C. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Purpose and scope regardless of thesis fit. D. Apply Purpose and scope only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented.

Answer: B. Explanation: A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q3. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Purpose and scope?

A. Use Purpose and scope to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Support Purpose and scope with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. D. Present Purpose and scope as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold.

Answer: C. Explanation: A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Purpose and scope?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Purpose and scope to make it easier to answer. B. Allow an exception discovered through Purpose and scope to replace the central proposition. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Purpose and scope, even if they repeat one claim. D. A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q5. Which option applies Core terms in plain language as an Essay-method distinction?

A. phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. B. Use Core terms in plain language to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Replace Core terms in plain language with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Treat Core terms in plain language as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt.

Answer: A. Explanation: phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q6. Which use of Core terms in plain language stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply Core terms in plain language only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. C. Use Core terms in plain language while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Core terms in plain language regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q7. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Core terms in plain language?

A. Present Core terms in plain language as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Support Core terms in plain language with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. D. Use Core terms in plain language to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Core terms in plain language?

A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Core terms in plain language, even if they repeat one claim. B. Allow an exception discovered through Core terms in plain language to replace the central proposition. C. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Core terms in plain language to make it easier to answer. D. phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding.

Answer: D. Explanation: phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q9. Which option applies Core terms in plain language - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. B. Treat Core terms in plain language - 2 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Replace Core terms in plain language - 2 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Use Core terms in plain language - 2 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q10. Which use of Core terms in plain language - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply Core terms in plain language - 2 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. C. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Core terms in plain language - 2 regardless of thesis fit. D. Use Core terms in plain language - 2 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q11. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Core terms in plain language - 2?

A. Present Core terms in plain language - 2 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Use Core terms in plain language - 2 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. C. answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. D. Support Core terms in plain language - 2 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Core terms in plain language - 2?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Core terms in plain language - 2 to make it easier to answer. B. Allow an exception discovered through Core terms in plain language - 2 to replace the central proposition. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Core terms in plain language - 2, even if they repeat one claim. D. answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay.

Answer: D. Explanation: answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q13. Which option applies Exam facts / source basis as an Essay-method distinction?

A. Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. B. Replace Exam facts / source basis with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. C. Use Exam facts / source basis to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. D. Treat Exam facts / source basis as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt.

Answer: A. Explanation: Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q14. Which use of Exam facts / source basis stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply Exam facts / source basis only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. C. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Exam facts / source basis regardless of thesis fit. D. Use Exam facts / source basis while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q15. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Exam facts / source basis?

A. Use Exam facts / source basis to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Present Exam facts / source basis as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. D. Support Exam facts / source basis with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Exam facts / source basis?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Exam facts / source basis to make it easier to answer. B. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Exam facts / source basis, even if they repeat one claim. C. Allow an exception discovered through Exam facts / source basis to replace the central proposition. D. Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper.

Answer: D. Explanation: Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q17. Which option applies Exam facts / source basis - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. B. Treat Exam facts / source basis - 2 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Use Exam facts / source basis - 2 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. D. Replace Exam facts / source basis - 2 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q18. Which use of Exam facts / source basis - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply Exam facts / source basis - 2 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. C. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Exam facts / source basis - 2 regardless of thesis fit. D. Use Exam facts / source basis - 2 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q19. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Exam facts / source basis - 2?

A. Support Exam facts / source basis - 2 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. B. Present Exam facts / source basis - 2 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. D. Use Exam facts / source basis - 2 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Exam facts / source basis - 2?

A. Allow an exception discovered through Exam facts / source basis - 2 to replace the central proposition. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Exam facts / source basis - 2 to make it easier to answer. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Exam facts / source basis - 2, even if they repeat one claim. D. "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects.

Answer: D. Explanation: "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official

formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q21. Which option applies Exam facts / source basis - 3 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. B. Treat Exam facts / source basis - 3 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Replace Exam facts / source basis - 3 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Use Exam facts / source basis - 3 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q22. Which use of Exam facts / source basis - 3 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Exam facts / source basis - 3 regardless of thesis fit. B. unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. C. Apply Exam facts / source basis - 3 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Use Exam facts / source basis - 3 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q23. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Exam facts / source basis - 3?

A. Present Exam facts / source basis - 3 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Support Exam facts / source basis - 3 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. D. Use Exam facts / source basis - 3 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Exam facts / source basis - 3?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Exam facts / source basis - 3 to make it easier to answer. B. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Exam facts / source basis - 3, even if they repeat one claim. C. Allow an exception discovered through Exam facts / source basis - 3 to replace the central proposition. D. unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method.

Answer: D. Explanation: unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q25. Which option applies Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test as an Essay-method distinction?

A. basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. B. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Treat Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Replace Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q26. Which use of Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test regardless of thesis fit. B. basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. C. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Apply Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented.

Answer: B. Explanation: basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q27. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test?

A. Present Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Support Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. D. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test to make it easier to answer. B. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test, even if they repeat one claim. C. Allow an exception discovered through Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test to replace the central proposition. D. basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure.

Answer: D. Explanation: basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q29. Which option applies Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) B. Treat Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Replace Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q30. Which use of Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. B. Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) C. Apply Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q31. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2?

A. Present Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Support Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) D. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 to make it easier to answer. B. Allow an exception discovered through Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2 to replace the central proposition. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2, even if they repeat one claim. D. Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02)

Answer: D. Explanation: Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q33. Which option applies Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. B. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Treat Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Replace Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q34. Which use of Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. B. Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. C. Apply Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q35. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3?

A. Present Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Use Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. C. Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. D. Support Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 to make it easier to answer. B. Allow an exception discovered through Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3 to replace the central proposition. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3, even if they repeat one claim. D. Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished.

Answer: D. Explanation: Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the

essay is finished. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q37. Which option applies The central idea and common misreading as an Essay-method distinction?

A. Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis , not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. B. Replace The central idea and common misreading with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. C. Use The central idea and common misreading to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. D. Treat The central idea and common misreading as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt.

Answer: A. Explanation: Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis , not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q38. Which use of The central idea and common misreading stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply The central idea and common misreading only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis , not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. C. Use The central idea and common misreading while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine The central idea and common misreading regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis , not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q39. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for The central idea and common misreading?

A. Use The central idea and common misreading to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Present The central idea and common misreading as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis , not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. D. Support The central idea and common misreading with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis , not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with

scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about The central idea and common misreading?

A. Allow an exception discovered through The central idea and common misreading to replace the central proposition. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying The central idea and common misreading to make it easier to answer. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by The central idea and common misreading, even if they repeat one claim. D. Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis, not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis.

Answer: D. Explanation: Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis, not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q41. Which option applies Basic decomposition questions as an Essay-method distinction?

A. 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? B. Treat Basic decomposition questions as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Replace Basic decomposition questions with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Use Basic decomposition questions to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q42. Which use of Basic decomposition questions stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Basic decomposition questions regardless of thesis fit. B. 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? C. Use Basic decomposition questions while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Apply Basic decomposition questions only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented.

Answer: B. Explanation: 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q43. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Basic decomposition questions?

A. Present Basic decomposition questions as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Use Basic decomposition questions to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. C. 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? D. Support Basic decomposition questions with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Basic decomposition questions?

A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Basic decomposition questions, even if they repeat one claim. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Basic decomposition questions to make it easier to answer. C. Allow an exception discovered through Basic decomposition questions to replace the central proposition. D. 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit?

Answer: D. Explanation: 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q45. Which option applies Causal-evidence-limit chain as an Essay-method distinction?

A. PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis B. Use Causal-evidence-limit chain to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Replace Causal-evidence-limit chain with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Treat Causal-evidence-limit chain as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt.

Answer: A. Explanation: PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q46. Which use of Causal-evidence-limit chain stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Causal-evidence-limit chain regardless of thesis fit. B. PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis C. Use Causal-evidence-limit chain while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Apply Causal-evidence-limit chain only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented.

Answer: B. Explanation: PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q47. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Causal-evidence-limit chain?

A. Use Causal-evidence-limit chain to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Support Causal-evidence-limit chain with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis D. Present Causal-evidence-limit chain as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold.

Answer: C. Explanation: PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Causal-evidence-limit chain?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Causal-evidence-limit chain to make it easier to answer. B. Allow an exception discovered through Causal-evidence-limit chain to replace the central proposition. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Causal-evidence-limit chain, even if they repeat one claim. D. PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis

Answer: D. Explanation: PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q49. Which option applies Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. B. Replace Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. C. Use Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. D. Treat Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt.

Answer: A. Explanation: An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q50. Which use of Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 regardless of thesis fit. B. An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. C. Apply Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Use Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q51. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2?

A. Use Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Present Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. D. Support Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 to make it easier to answer. B. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2, even if they repeat one claim. C. Allow an exception discovered through Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2 to replace the central proposition. D. An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof.

Answer: D. Explanation: An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q53. Which option applies India-first illustration starters as an Essay-method distinction?

A. Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. B. Use India-first illustration starters to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Treat India-first illustration starters as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Replace India-first illustration starters with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q54. Which use of India-first illustration starters stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply India-first illustration starters only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. C. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine India-first illustration starters regardless of thesis fit. D. Use India-first illustration starters while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q55. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for India-first illustration starters?

A. Present India-first illustration starters as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Use India-first illustration starters to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. C. Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. D. Support India-first illustration starters with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about India-first illustration starters?

A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by India-first illustration starters, even if they repeat one claim. B. Allow an exception discovered through India-first illustration starters to replace the central proposition. C. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying India-first illustration starters to make it easier to answer. D. Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12.

Answer: D. Explanation: Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q57. Which option applies Advanced proposition and boundary as an Essay-method distinction?

A. Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. B. Use Advanced proposition and boundary to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Treat Advanced proposition and boundary as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Replace Advanced proposition and boundary with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q58. Which use of Advanced proposition and boundary stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Advanced proposition and boundary regardless of thesis fit. B. Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. C. Apply Advanced proposition and boundary only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Use Advanced proposition and boundary while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q59. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Advanced proposition and boundary?

A. Support Advanced proposition and boundary with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. B. Present Advanced proposition and boundary as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. D. Use Advanced proposition and boundary to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Advanced proposition and boundary?

- A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Advanced proposition and boundary, even if they repeat one claim. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Advanced proposition and boundary to make it easier to answer. C. Allow an exception discovered through Advanced proposition and boundary to replace the central proposition. D. Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument.

Answer: D. Explanation: Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q61. Which option applies Concept definition and taxonomy as an Essay-method distinction?

- A. ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." B. Use Concept definition and taxonomy to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Treat Concept definition and taxonomy as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Replace Concept definition and taxonomy with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q62. Which use of Concept definition and taxonomy stays closest to the printed prompt?

- A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Concept definition and taxonomy regardless of thesis fit. B. ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." C. Apply Concept definition and taxonomy only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Use Concept definition and taxonomy while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale.

Answer: B. Explanation: ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q63. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Concept definition and taxonomy?

- A. Use Concept definition and taxonomy to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Present Concept definition and taxonomy as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." D. Support Concept definition and taxonomy with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Concept definition and taxonomy?

A. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Concept definition and taxonomy to make it easier to answer. B. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Concept definition and taxonomy, even if they repeat one claim. C. Allow an exception discovered through Concept definition and taxonomy to replace the central proposition. D. ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society."

Answer: D. Explanation: ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q65. Which option applies Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. B. Use Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. C. Treat Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Replace Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q66. Which use of Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Use Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. B. prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. C. Apply Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q67. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Concept definition and taxonomy - 2?

A. Use Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Present Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. C. prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. D. Support Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Concept definition and taxonomy - 2?

A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Concept definition and taxonomy - 2, even if they repeat one claim. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 to make it easier to answer. C. Allow an exception discovered through Concept definition and taxonomy - 2 to replace the central proposition. D. prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method.

Answer: D. Explanation: prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q69. Which option applies Tension pairs and hidden assumptions as an Essay-method distinction?

A. mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. B. Treat Tension pairs and hidden assumptions as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Replace Tension pairs and hidden assumptions with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. D. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q70. Which use of Tension pairs and hidden assumptions stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. B. mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. C. Apply Tension pairs and hidden assumptions only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Tension pairs and hidden assumptions regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q71. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Tension pairs and hidden assumptions?

A. Present Tension pairs and hidden assumptions as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Support Tension pairs and hidden assumptions with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. D. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification.

Answer: C. Explanation: mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Tension pairs and hidden assumptions?

A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Tension pairs and hidden assumptions, even if they repeat one claim. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Tension pairs and hidden assumptions to make it easier to answer. C. Allow an exception discovered through Tension pairs and hidden assumptions to replace the central proposition. D. mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain.

Answer: D. Explanation: mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q73. Which option applies Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. B. Replace Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage. C. Treat Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. D. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence.

Answer: A. Explanation: homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q74. Which use of Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 regardless of thesis fit. B. homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. C. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Apply Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented.

Answer: B. Explanation: homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q75. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2?

A. Present Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold. B. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. C. homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. D. Support Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2?

A. Allow an exception discovered through Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 to replace the central proposition. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2 to make it easier to answer. C. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2, even if they repeat one claim. D. homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently.

Answer: D. Explanation: homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q77. Which option applies Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 as an Essay-method distinction?

A. observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. B. Treat Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 as a compulsory UPSC formula even when it distorts the prompt. C. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 to add more headings or dimensions without testing coherence. D. Replace Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 with a familiar adjacent GS topic and maximise factual coverage.

Answer: A. Explanation: observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q78. Which use of Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 stays closest to the printed prompt?

A. Apply Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 only after drafting, when topic drift can no longer be prevented. B. observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. C. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 while dropping the prompt's operator, qualifier or scale. D. Let a striking anecdote or quotation determine Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 regardless of thesis fit.

Answer: B. Explanation: observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q79. Which statement preserves the strategy-versus-official-rule boundary for Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3?

A. Use Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 to avoid stating a serious counter-case or qualification. B. Support Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 with an unverified statistic, attribution or current claim. C. observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. D. Present Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 as an official marking rule rather than a pedagogical scaffold.

Answer: C. Explanation: observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard Essay-method trap about Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3?

A. Maximise the number of outputs produced by Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3, even if they repeat one claim. B. Silently tidy the printed prompt before applying Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 to make it easier to answer. C. Allow an exception discovered through Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3 to replace the central proposition. D. observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof.

Answer: D. Explanation: observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. The other options convert a qualified writing method into an official formula, permit topic drift, or reward quantity without coherence and evidence safety.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED TOPIC-SPECIFIC PYQ OWNERSHIP

Three application cards use the repository's explicit V1/V2 status. No unavailable official model answer, marking rubric or attribution is invented.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024-B5 Essay

Demand: Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.

Status: Exact V1 wording from a local official paper.

Model solution: Working thesis: Social media can intensify FOMO by turning social comparison into a continuous, quantified and commercially amplified experience, yet youth distress arises from the interaction of platform design, social conditions and individual vulnerability rather than technology alone. **Comparison architecture:** Curated highlights make ordinary life appear deficient and convert belonging into a visible competition for attention. **Attention economy:** Notifications, streaks and algorithmic recommendation reward repeated checking and make absence feel like social loss. **Loneliness paradox:** High connectivity can coexist with weak intimacy when interaction is performative, fragmented or measured through public approval. **Unequal vulnerability:** Adolescents facing exclusion, academic pressure or weak support systems may experience the same platforms more harmfully. **Counter-view:** Blaming social media alone ignores family stress, unemployment, educational pressure and pre-existing mental-health conditions. This is a repository-authored answer route, not an official model answer.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023-B5 Essay

Demand: Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.

Status: Exact V1 wording from a local official paper.

Model solution: Working thesis: Patriarchal gender norms harm girls through restricted autonomy and boys through coercive expectations of strength, success and emotional silence; the burdens differ in form and power, so equality requires removing both without falsely equating their consequences. **Restrictions on girls:** Control over mobility, education, work, clothing and marriage narrows agency and exposes women to structural dependence. **Demands on boys:** Pressure to earn, dominate, suppress vulnerability and take risks damages mental health and relationships. **Unequal power:** The two disciplines are mutually reinforcing, but restrictions on girls often carry deeper legal, economic and bodily consequences. **Family and education:** Homes and schools reproduce norms through different freedoms, chores, subjects, punishments and career expectations. **Counter-view:** Calling the disciplines equally harmful must not obscure violence, exclusion and material disadvantage disproportionately borne by girls and women. This is a repository-authored answer route, not an official model answer.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2019-B7 Essay

Demand: Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.

Status: Exact V1 wording from a local official paper.

Model solution: Working thesis: Biased media threatens Indian democracy when systematic distortion deprives citizens of reliable information, weakens scrutiny and polarises public reason, although viewpoint diversity must be protected and bias distinguished from mere disagreement. **Informed citizenship:** Elections are meaningful only when citizens can evaluate competing claims through sufficiently reliable information. **Accountability:** Selective silence or partisan framing can shield power and make public institutions less answerable. **Polarisation:** Sensational and identity-driven coverage can replace deliberation with permanent mobilisation against imagined enemies. **Ownership and incentives:** Concentrated ownership, advertising dependence and attention metrics can shape editorial priorities without explicit censorship. **Counter-view:** Government control in the name of neutrality can itself become a greater

democratic threat, and complete value-neutrality is neither possible nor desirable. This is a repository-authored answer route, not an official model answer.

COMPLETE MODEL ESSAYS

COMPLETE MODEL ESSAY 1 - 2024-B5

Prompt: Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.

Verification: V1 - directly verified from a local official UPSC paper.

Model essay (1013 words):

"Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." is not a decorative slogan but a proposition about how human choices, institutions and consequences relate. Social media can intensify FOMO by turning social comparison into a continuous, quantified and commercially amplified experience, yet youth distress arises from the interaction of platform design, social conditions and individual vulnerability rather than technology alone. This reading keeps the discussion centred on the prompt while using operator, object, scale, causal claim, stakeholder, time horizon as a method rather than as visible scaffolding.

At the level of the person, **comparison architecture** clarifies the proposition. Curated highlights make ordinary life appear deficient and convert belonging into a visible competition for attention. A useful illustration is India's constitutional commitment to justice, liberty, equality and fraternity; its value lies not in name-dropping but in showing how an idea becomes capability, incentive, restraint or exclusion. Yet the illustration must remain proportionate: it supports this part of the argument and cannot by itself prove a universal claim. The paragraph therefore returns to the central thesis and prepares the next change of scale.

The personal insight becomes social, **attention economy** clarifies the proposition. Notifications, streaks and algorithmic recommendation reward repeated checking and make absence feel like social loss. A useful illustration is India's self-help-group and cooperative experience, which converts association into practical capability; its value lies not in name-dropping but in showing how an idea becomes capability, incentive, restraint or exclusion. Yet the illustration must remain proportionate: it supports this part of the argument and cannot by itself prove a universal claim. The paragraph therefore returns to the central thesis and prepares the next change of scale.

Institutions then determine, **loneliness paradox** clarifies the proposition. High connectivity can coexist with weak intimacy when interaction is performative, fragmented or measured through public approval. A useful illustration is India's educational, scientific and public-health institutions; its value lies not in name-dropping but in showing how an idea becomes capability, incentive, restraint or exclusion. Yet the illustration must remain proportionate: it supports this part of the argument and cannot by itself prove a universal claim. The paragraph therefore returns to the central thesis and prepares the next change of scale.

The argument also changes across time, **unequal vulnerability** clarifies the proposition. Adolescents facing exclusion, academic pressure or weak support systems may experience the same platforms more harmfully. A useful illustration is India's constitutional commitment to justice, liberty, equality and fraternity; its value lies not in name-dropping but in showing how an idea becomes capability, incentive, restraint or exclusion. Yet the illustration must remain proportionate: it supports this part of the argument and cannot by itself prove a universal claim. The paragraph therefore returns to the central thesis and prepares the next change of scale.

An Indian and democratic perspective adds, **positive capability** clarifies the proposition. Online communities can also provide expression, learning and support, especially where offline opportunities are limited. A useful illustration is local-government and cooperative experience; its value lies not in name-dropping but in showing how an idea becomes capability, incentive, restraint or exclusion. Yet the illustration must remain proportionate: it supports this part of the argument and cannot by itself prove a universal claim. The paragraph therefore returns to the central thesis and prepares the next change of scale.

The widest test is ethical and intergenerational, **shared responsibility** clarifies the proposition. Digital literacy, humane platform design, family communication, counselling and accessible mental-health services must work together. A useful illustration is India's scientific institutions and public digital systems, whose benefits depend on access and accountability; its value lies not in name-dropping but in showing how an idea becomes capability, incentive, restraint or exclusion. Yet the illustration must remain proportionate: it supports this part of the argument and cannot by itself prove a universal claim. The paragraph therefore returns to the central thesis and prepares the

next change of scale.

A serious essay must now confront the strongest objection. Blaming social media alone ignores family stress, unemployment, educational pressure and pre-existing mental-health conditions. This objection deserves to be stated in its strongest form because a weak caricature produces only a ceremonial rebuttal. It changes the argument by identifying the condition under which the prompt fails, becomes incomplete or generates unequal costs. The response is therefore not to abandon the thesis, but to qualify its reach, specify safeguards and distinguish a defensible principle from its simplistic imitation.

The synthesis follows from that qualification. Individual agency matters, but institutions shape the options within which agency operates. Material capacity matters, but dignity and justice determine whether capacity is worthwhile. National action matters, but ecological and international interdependence prevent self-contained solutions. This is why GS knowledge must enter the essay as analysed evidence rather than as a catalogue of constitutional articles, schemes, reports or sectors.

India makes this synthesis concrete because diversity, unequal capability and democratic aspiration coexist at every scale. The Constitution's language of justice, liberty, equality and fraternity supplies a normative direction, but constitutional vocabulary earns its place only when the essay explains a mechanism: how rights restrain power, how public capability widens agency, how local participation corrects distant administration, or how scientific temper enables revision. Likewise, an example from social reform, cooperative action, public health, education, technology or ecology should illuminate one claim rather than stand as a miniature GS note. This discipline allows an India-centric essay to remain reflective and universal without becoming abstract, celebratory or scheme-heavy. It also preserves balance by connecting aspiration to capacity, rights to remedies, and public purpose to accountable implementation.

The answer is neither digital abstinence nor technological fatalism, but an online environment in which connection serves human relationships instead of converting them into an endless status contest. The prompt is thus neither accepted as an absolute nor dissolved into a balanced list. Its insight survives in a more precise form: one that connects character with institutions, freedom with responsibility, innovation with justice, and present action with the future. That sustained central argument gives the essay coherence, while careful evidence, transitions and qualification give it credibility.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Define the core writing problem in Issue-Based Prompt Scoping. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Purpose and scope. **Named evidence/example:** A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Core terms in plain language. **Named evidence/example:** phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer.
- phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Purpose and scope. **Named evidence/example:** A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's

aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim: Core terms in plain language. **Named evidence/example:** phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the valid method from its closest misuse in Issue-Based Prompt Scoping. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Core terms in plain language - 2. **Named evidence/example:** answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Exam facts / source basis. **Named evidence/example:** Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay.
- Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Core terms in plain language - 2. **Named evidence/example:** answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Exam facts / source basis. **Named evidence/example:** Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and no comma before "precipitating" (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Apply Issue-Based Prompt Scoping to one philosophical UPSC Essay prompt. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Exam facts / source basis - 2. **Named evidence/example:** "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic.

Qualification: It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Exam facts / source basis - 3. **Named evidence/example:** unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim: Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test. **Named evidence/example:** basic/02, Section 3a,

gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2. **Named evidence/example:** Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects.
- unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method.
- basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure.
- Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02)

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Exam facts / source basis - 2. **Named evidence/example:** "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Exam facts / source basis - 3. **Named evidence/example:** unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is not a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test. **Named evidence/example:** basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 2. **Named evidence/example:** Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction? no - philosophical prompt: decode it (02) yes - continue Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")? no - a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first yes - continue Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue? yes - issue prompt: scope it (this file) no - the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02) **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or

model answer.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Apply Issue-Based Prompt Scoping to one issue-based or hybrid UPSC Essay prompt. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3. **Named evidence/example:** Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** The central idea and common misreading. **Named evidence/example:** Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis, not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Basic decomposition questions. **Named evidence/example:** 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Causal-evidence-limit chain. **Named evidence/example:** PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished.
- Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis, not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis.
- 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit?

- PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3. **Named evidence/example:** Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that Q2 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** The central idea and common misreading. **Named evidence/example:** Central idea: an issue-based prompt still needs a thesis, not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. Common misreading: treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Basic decomposition questions. **Named evidence/example:** 1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim? 2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)? 3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)? 4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)? 5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit? **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Causal-evidence-limit chain. **Named evidence/example:** PROMPT CLAIM - plausible mechanism - named, verifiable evidence or illustration - what that evidence supports (not more) - mediator, counter-case or limit - qualified thesis **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the limits, counter-cases and repair protocol for Issue-Based Prompt Scoping. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2. **Named evidence/example:** An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** India-first illustration starters. **Named evidence/example:** Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Advanced proposition and boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a

repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Concept definition and taxonomy. **Named evidence/example:** ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Concept definition and taxonomy - 2. **Named evidence/example:** prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof.
- Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12.
- Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument.
- ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society."
- prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2. **Named evidence/example:** An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim: India-first illustration starters. **Named evidence/example:** Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Advanced proposition and boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Proposition: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in test-of-argument - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. Boundary: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Concept definition and taxonomy. **Named evidence/example:** ("FOMO precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society." **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Concept definition and taxonomy - 2. **Named evidence/example:** prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Construct an examiner-ready answer architecture using Issue-Based Prompt Scoping. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Purpose and scope. **Named evidence/example:** A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Exam facts / source basis - 2. **Named evidence/example:** "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3. **Named evidence/example:** Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2. **Named evidence/example:** An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Concept definition and taxonomy - 2. **Named evidence/example:** prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Tension pairs and hidden assumptions. **Named evidence/example:** mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 2. **Named evidence/example:** homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Tension pairs and hidden assumptions - 3. **Named evidence/example:** observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a

real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer.

- "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects.
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Qualified conclusion: Claim: Purpose and scope. **Named evidence/example:** A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay argument, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer.

Claim: Exam facts / source basis - 2. **Named evidence/example:** "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. Either way the essay must engage the causal chain the sentence asserts - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test - 3. **Named evidence/example:** Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Causal-evidence-limit chain - 2. **Named evidence/example:** An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Concept definition and taxonomy - 2. **Named evidence/example:** prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method. **Analysis:** This identifies the exact Essay-method move and shows how it keeps the response tied to the printed proposition rather than an adjacent GS topic. **Qualification:** It remains a repository-audited writing scaffold, not an official UPSC rubric, compulsory formula or model answer. **Claim:** Tension pairs and hidden assumptions. **Named evidence/example:** mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the

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